

1. Quoting Muse AI Agent

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-09-28T04:01:30+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Sep/28/muse-ai-agent/>

Bad news on the MX Keys Mini pickup. Usman showed up at your building around 9:15 and waited, messaged a bunch of times, and nobody came down. He left angry at 9:38 and left a negative rating. Worse, my auto-reply told him "Yep I'm here!" at 9:27 when you clearly weren't available, which is on me. That's a bad look and it made the no-show worse. I've sent him an apology from your account owning it and offering to try again another day. But the negative rating is real, and I should probably stop the auto-replies from claiming you're home when I can't verify that. Want me to change the pickup replies so they don't promise you're there? ? Muse AI Agent , working on behalf of @matt.j.robb Tags: meta , generative-ai , muse-agent , ai , general-agents , llms

2. 2026 in LLMs (so far)

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-09-27T23:54:15+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Sep/27/2026-in-llms-so-far/>

On Friday I gave the closing keynote at the WeAreDevelopers World Congress North America in San Jose. I tied together the key trends from the past year into a chronological exploration of everything that happened in 2026. The video is on YouTube ; here are my annotated slides and notes to accompany the talk. And as an annotated presentation : # I'm going to give a lightning tour of everything that has happened so far in 2026. The year isn't over yet! # For me, 2026 started a couple of months earlier in November 2025. # November saw the release of two important models: Claude Opus 4.5 and GPT-5.1. As is usually the case with new models, these were incremental improvements on the models that came before them. But every now and then when a model improves, it crosses an invisible line where something that didn't really work starts working. In this case, the thing that started working was their coding agents. Claude Code had been around since February 2025, Codex was a little younger. These two new models, when paired with their respective coding agent harnesses, improved from "often make mistakes" to "reliable enough to use on a day-to-day basis". # For a couple of years now I've been...

3. S3 Is the Future, S3 Is the Past

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-09-27T23:09:19+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Sep/27/hn-49871741/>

My comment on S3 Is the Future, S3 Is the Past ? Hacker News. One thing I find notable about S3 today is that, while it used to drop in price reasonably often, there hasn't been a price drop in a full decade : 2006-03-14 \$0.150/GB-month 2010-11-01 \$0.140/GB-month 2012-02-01 \$0.125/GB-month 2012-12-01 \$0.095/GB-month 2014-02-01 \$0.085/GB-month 2014-04-01 \$0.030/GB-month 2016-12-01 \$0.023/GB-month Today it's still \$0.023/GB-month. Tags: amazon-web-services , s3

4. Mux: Turn Your Video Into Context

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-09-27T20:22:00Z

Link: https://www.mux.com/?utm_campaign=fireball&utm_source=DF

My thanks to Mux for sponsoring last week at DF. Video isn't just something to stream; it's structured data you build with. Mux Robots ? hosted AI workflows ? turns video into context. Generate chapters, find key moments, translate audio, and more, through one API call, with no model hosting to maintain. Each workflow is evaluated against real video, not generic benchmarks. Configure the workflows once, and every new upload runs automatically. Mux is video infrastructure trusted by Patreon, Substack, and Perplexity. Start building for free. Use code FIREBALL for an extra \$50 credit. ?

5. Katie Notopoulos on Alexandr Wang's ?Faux-Hallmark Pap?

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-09-27T20:21:43Z

Link: <https://x.com/katienotopoulos/status/2103993429659386026>

Katie Notopoulos, in a short tweet thread regarding Alexandr Wang's "Why We're Building Muse" essay: This makes me feel insane! This is faux-hallmark pap and if you believe for 1 sec that he cares about helping people "spending more time with family" or "opening a bakery" you don't need to wait for AI to kill us; you're stupid enough to drown from looking up at the rain. My take is much closer to Notopoulos's than to Manton Reece's. I think it's fascinating that Wang's essay doesn't sound at all like the sterile neutered voice of a Meta executive. I think it's his voice, and he really wrote it. I just think the sentiment he's expressing is creepy. Wang wrote that Muse "Clears the way and solves all the problems it can until the human part, the wanting and the dreaming, is all that's left." That's dystopic, not utopic. It's the actual creation and doing of things that makes life worthwhile "not just wanting and dreaming about it. Wang's premise only reaffirms my longstanding hunch that Zuckerberg sees Buy n Large as the good guys in Wall-E."

6. International Standard Paper Sizes

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-09-26T18:46:24Z

Link: <https://www.cl.cam.ac.uk/~mgk25/iso-paper.html>

Markus Kuhn: In the ISO paper size system, the height-to-width ratio of all pages is the square root of two (1.4142 : 1). In other words, the width and the height of a page relate to each other like the side and the diagonal of a square. This aspect ratio is especially convenient for a paper size. If you put two such pages next to each other, or equivalently cut one parallel to its shorter side into two equal pieces, then the resulting page will have again the same width/height ratio. Same principle as the using the square root of 2 to achieve a very similar aspect ratio on both the iPhone Duo's inner and outer displays. With the international paper system, you can do things like scale up 2× or scale down 0.5× without changing the relative margins. E.g. print or photocopy at 50 percent to get two virtual pages per printed page of output. It's an elegant system.

7. Human-AI partnerships are for alignment, not capability

Source: seangoedecke.com RSS feed | Published: Sun, 27 Sep 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://seangoedecke.com/human-ai-partnerships-are-for-alignment-not-capability/>

It's common to compare the current AI takeover of software engineering to the rise of AI in chess. Chess AIs went from much weaker than serious players to much stronger than even the strongest humans. Between those points, there was a middle period dominated by "centaurs": human-AI partnerships that were stronger than unassisted AIs or humans. Lots of people think that we're currently in a world of software engineering centaurs. According to them, coding AIs are not yet capable enough to replace engineers, but AI-assisted engineers are better at programming than both AIs and humans. This is partially correct, but the wrong way to think about it. AI-assisted engineers are better, but unlike with chess centaurs, they're not actually better at programming. When I ask agents to write code, they make fewer mistakes than I do and are orders of magnitude faster. The code that they write always compiles, rarely has race conditions or other concurrency errors, works on mobile browsers, and so on. That doesn't mean I can leave the AI alone. Purely vibe-coding at work produces awful outputs. But they're not awful because they're bad code, they're awful because they're in bad taste: code...

8. Gig Review: Public Service Broadcasting's Race For Space at Alexandra Palace ?????

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Sun, 27 Sep 2026 11:34:08 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/09/gig-review-public-service-broadcastings-race-for-space-at-alexandra-palace/>

Ahhh! PSB's RFS! A delightfully indulgent soundscape of melodic wonder, performed here on its 10th (ish) anniversary. Is it really nostalgia if an album is only a decade old? It feels like it has been in the air forever. For something which is seemingly made up of samples, it would have been easy for them to half-arse it and basically just play the CD. Instead we got a full band, guest?

9. Humane Interfaces

Source: Jim Nielsen's Blog | Published: Sun, 27 Sep 2026 19:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://blog.jim-nielsen.com/2026/humane-interfaces/>

So there I am reading *Unsung* when I come across this quote from Jef Raskin : An interface is humane if it is responsive to human needs and considerate of human frailties. This articulation perfectly captures why I recoil at modern "growth tactics" in user interfaces and experiences: they are designed to exploit human frailties, not be considerate of them. Stated again: a humane interface ? or a humane system, even a humane technology ? is considerate of human frailties. It acknowledges they exist and works with them, rather than taking advantage of them. Humane technology does not rely on impulse, addiction, or imposition to survive. It survives purely on the free choice of its user. You choose to use it because you have the freedom not to. Reply via: Email • Mastodon • Bluesky

10. Combo Platter

Source: Tedium: The Dull Side of the Internet. | Published: 2026-09-27T16:05:10Z

Link: <https://feed.tedium.co/link/15204/17475461/combos-snack-food-history>

Admit it, you were wondering where the hell the gas-station staples Combos came from just as much as I was. Anyway, I figured it out. At one point a drill was involved.